“I have to hide my struggles from other Christians.”

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Where it often comes from

If we have seen others gossiped about, or if our church culture praises victory and quiets doubt, we learn to say “I’m fine.” We fear that sharing a struggle with anxiety, marriage, money, or temptation will cost us respect or leadership. So we smile, pray alone, and hurt in secret.

What Scripture teaches

James writes, “Confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so that you may be healed.” Paul says, “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ.” John says, “If we walk in the light as He is in the light, we have fellowship with one another.” Proverbs warns, “He who conceals his sins will not prosper, but whoever confesses and renounces them will find mercy.” Not every person is safe, and wisdom is needed in choosing whom to tell. But God designed healing to happen among His people, not in isolation.

> *“Therefore confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so that you may be healed. The prayer of a righteous man has great power to prevail”* (James 5:16).

Also see

> “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ” (Galatians 6:2).

> “But if we walk in the light as He is in the light, we have fellowship with one another, and the blood of Jesus His Son cleanses us from all sin” (1 John 1:7).

> “He who conceals his sins will not prosper, but whoever confesses and renounces them will find mercy” (Proverbs 28:13).

> “And let us consider how to spur one another on to love and good deeds. Let us not neglect meeting together, as some have made a habit, but let us encourage one another, and all the more as you see the Day approaching” (Hebrews 10:24–25).

Common self-statements

- If I tell, they will think less of me.
- Strong Christians do not struggle.
- I have to keep it together.
- They will gossip.
- I have to handle this alone.
- Sharing will cost me my position.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting negative reactions.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must tell everyone or no one.
- Should statements: Insisting that Christians should not struggle.
- Catastrophizing: Imagining loss of respect and position.

Challenging questions

- What struggle am I hiding, and from whom?
- What has hiding cost me so far?
- Is there one mature, trustworthy believer I could tell?
- What has God designed for confession and prayer?
- What happens to wounds that stay in the dark?
- What would a safe first step look like?

Truth summary

> God made us to carry burdens together. With wise, trustworthy people, I can share my struggles and receive prayer and support. I do not have to handle everything alone, and I do not have to tell everyone.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Confession
- Church
- Friendship
- Sinful Nature
- Help

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Communication

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Broken Things — Matthew West
God can work through imperfect people without waiting for them to become flawless.

Worn — Tenth Avenue North
Weariness can be expressed honestly while asking God for restoration.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I have to hide my struggles from other Christians"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I have to hide my struggles from other Christians." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What am I hiding?
- ☐ What has hiding cost?
- ☐ Who is safe?
- ☐ What will I say?
- ☐ What do I need in response?
- ☐ How will I follow up?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ We are meant to carry burdens together.
- ☐ Confession and prayer lead to healing.
- ☐ Light brings fellowship.
- ☐ Hiding keeps wounds hidden.
- ☐ Safe people exist.
- ☐ I can share wisely.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ James 5:16
  "Therefore confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so that you may be healed. The prayer of a righteous man has great power to prevail."
- ☐ Galatians 6:2
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."
- ☐ 1 John 1:7
  "But if we walk in the light as He is in the light, we have fellowship with one another, and the blood of Jesus His Son cleanses us from all sin."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Brought into the light: Each week, record one step in sharing a struggle with a safe person.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, James 5:16 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I can confess and pray with others so that I may be healed.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Confession" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Name the struggle. Write what you are hiding.
- [ ] Choose wisely. Identify one person known for confidentiality and grace.
- [ ] Share briefly. Tell part of it and see how they respond.
- [ ] Ask for prayer. Request regular prayer or check-ins.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I have to hide my struggles from other Christians": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Brought into the light
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I have to hide my struggles from other Christians.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have been carrying this alone. Lead me to a wise and trustworthy person with whom I can share. Heal me through Your people, and use my honesty to help others. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.